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Mentoring and supporting women. What can be done?



Jaya Jagadish, AMD

From my own experience, I know how an empowered woman can positively impact and support another woman. I was personally mentored by my organization's CEO, Dr Lisa Su, a stalwart in the semiconductor industry. I pass on the light by mentoring women managers through formal and informal sessions within and outside AMD. During these discussions, we touch upon various aspects related to problem solving, decision making, people management, and work-life balance.



Geetha Adinarayan, IBM

I believe in 'what you get is what you give'. At IBM, I have been fortunate to be mentored by great leaders. Now, I see it as my duty in doing the same for young technologists to share them into future leaders. I work closely in mentoring interns, early professional hires and experienced professionals. It's an opportunity to understand various perspectives and nurture people with different roles and expectations.



Irina Ghose, Microsoft

There's a big need in the industry at all levels to ensure that women can move from early to mid-career and sustain till leadership levels. At my philanthropic foundation MyLittleBit, we began by setting up a digital literacy lab for underprivileged girls in a government school and training the teachers on tools like PowerPoint, Word, and Excel. The foundation's work has scaled since then to cover the entire spectrum from providing scholarships in STEM education to training them and getting them placed in jobs.



Priya Murthy, Acer

Some employees will leap at the chance to broaden their horizons and learn new things, but others may want aid in realising their potential or prefer the concept of project management over people management. I believe in engaging with people one on one and nurturing them toward success. It's also critical to provide constructive feedback so that they can improve their talents and develop into future leaders.



Kavitha Prasad, Intel

To develop leaders, mentorship alone is not enough. So often, women tend to be over-mentored and not sponsored. I believe that while mentoring emerging leaders and being their sounding board is important, we must also be their biggest and loudest advocates when they are not in the room. The balance of these two areas is crucial when developing strong leaders.